ENG520 SHORT HANDOUTS MIDTERM

Lesson 01 to 05

(ENG520) Testing and Assessment

EFFORT BY VUHELPERS24 TEAM

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Lesson 01

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CONCEPT OF ASSESSMENT-I

Topic - 001: Measurement, Assessment and Evaluation Measurement

What is measurement in the context of education?

Measurement is the process of quantifying attributes or dimensions of objects, whether physical or abstract, using tools such as tests, observations, checklists, homework, portfolios, and projects.

Why is measurement in the field of education challenging compared to physical measurements?

Education deals with abstract variables like attitudes, behaviors, and achievement, which are not directly measurable like physical objects. Tools used for measuring these variables cannot measure as precisely as a physical scale or thermometer.

What is the purpose of assessment in education?

Assessment aims to appraise teaching and learning processes to determine how they can be improved, ultimately enhancing the quality of education.

How does evaluation differ from assessment in education?

Evaluation involves making judgments about the quality and extent of learning in relation to intended learning outcomes. Assessment focuses on improving the teaching and learning process, while evaluation examines the achievement of objectives.

Explain the role of assessment and evaluation in a classroom situation.

Assessment helps teachers reflect on their teaching methods and whether students are learning effectively. Evaluation is used to measure the quality and quantity of student learning against specific objectives.

Differentiate between measurement, assessment, and evaluation in education.

Measurement is the process of obtaining information, assessment is about using this information to improve teaching and learning, and evaluation is about determining how well students have achieved the learning objectives.

Explain the difference between measurement, assessment, and evaluation.

Measurement involves the process of obtaining information, assessment focuses on using this information to enhance teaching and learning, and evaluation aims to determine the quality and quantity of learning against specific objectives.

Topic - 002: Classroom Assessment

What is classroom assessment?

Classroom assessment is the process of gathering, recording, interpreting, using, and communicating information about a student's progress and achievement in knowledge, concepts, skills, and attitudes.

How can classroom assessment be classified?

Classroom assessment can be classified based on nature, format, use in classroom instruction, and method of interpreting results.

Name the four categories of classroom assessment based on use in classroom instruction.

The four categories are placement assessment, formative assessment, diagnostic assessment, and summative assessment.

Topic - 003: Types of Assessment

What are the two types of assessment by nature?

The two types are maximum performance assessment and typical performance assessment.

What is the focus of maximum performance assessment?

Maximum performance assessment determines what individuals can do when performing at their best, either to measure past success (achievement) or predict future success (aptitude).

What is the emphasis of typical performance assessment?

Typical performance assessment focuses on what individuals will do under natural conditions, often assessing attitudes, interests, personality, and observable behaviors.

What are the two types of assessment by format?

The two types are fixed choice assessment and complex performance assessment.

Describe maximum performance assessment and its purpose.

Maximum performance assessment assesses what individuals can do when performing at their best. It is used to measure how well students perform under optimal conditions, for example, to indicate the degree of success in past learning activities or to predict success in future learning activities.

Describe complex performance assessment and its applications.

Complex performance assessment is designed to measure performance in real-life contexts, evaluating tasks and problems valued for their own sake. It involves hands-on laboratory experiments, projects, essays, and oral presentations, making it suitable for assessing higher-level skills and abilities.

How is fixed choice assessment different from complex performance assessment?

Fixed choice assessment uses multiple choice questions, matching exercises, and other predefined response formats to efficiently measure lower-level knowledge and skills. Complex performance assessment, on the other hand, assesses performance in real-life contexts, often using hands-on experiments, projects, essays, and oral presentations.

Lesson 02

CONCEPT OF ASSESSMENT-II

Topic 004: Use of Assessment in Classroom Instruction

What is placement assessment?

Answer: Placement assessment determines a student's prior knowledge, skills, and readiness for a particular course.

How can placement assessment help teachers in the classroom?

Placement assessment helps teachers plan lessons based on students' current knowledge and skills, and it determines the level at which a student should be placed.

What are some examples of placement assessment tools?

Examples of placement assessment tools include readiness tests, aptitude tests, pretests, and self-report inventories.

What is diagnostic assessment, and when is it used?

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Diagnostic assessment identifies the causes of persistent learning difficulties and is used when a student continues to experience failure despite using alternative methods.

What is placement assessment, and why is it used?

Placement assessment is used to determine a student's prerequisite skills, the extent of mastery of course objectives, and their mode of learning. It helps assess a student's prior knowledge to decide their entry level, ensuring they have the necessary knowledge for a particular course. It also aids in placing students appropriately according to their existing knowledge and helps in lesson planning. Additionally, placement assessment can reveal a student's interests and aptitude for a subject, aiding in career path selection.

Topic 005: Use of Assessment in Classroom Instruction – Formative and Summative Assessments

What is formative assessment, and how does it differ from summative assessment?

Formative assessment focuses on providing feedback to improve the learning process during instruction, while summative assessment is used to measure overall achievement at the end of a course.

How does formative assessment benefit teachers and students?

Formative assessment provides feedback to teachers on their teaching methods and helps students reflect on their weaknesses, encouraging successful learning.

What is the primary purpose of summative assessment?

Summative assessment's primary purpose is to assign grades and certify students' mastery in a subject at the end of a course.

Give examples of summative assessment techniques.

Examples of summative assessment techniques include teacher-made achievement tests, surveys, rating scales, and product scales.

What are the key benefits of formative assessment for both teachers and students?

Formative assessment benefits teachers by providing insights into the strengths and weaknesses of the learning process, allowing them to modify their teaching practices to enhance the learning experience. It helps students reflect on their weaknesses, encouraging them to engage in successful learning. This type of assessment ensures that students struggling with specific content areas or concepts receive timely feedback for improvement. The critical distinction between formative and summative assessment is that formative assessment focuses on enhancing the learning process rather than certifying students' achievement. Various tools can be employed for formative assessment, including teacher-made tests and customized tests from textbooks.

Topic 006: Types of Assessment: Methods of Interpreting Results

What is norm-referenced assessment, and how is it used?

Norm-referenced assessment compares a student's performance to a known group and is not used for certification but for distinguishing between groups. It often reports students' positions relative to others using percentiles.

Provide examples of norm-referenced tests.

Examples of norm-referenced tests include NTS or CSS exams, where percentile scores indicate a student's relative standing.

What is criterion-referenced assessment, and what is its primary purpose?

Criterion-referenced assessment compares students' performance against specific, predefined criteria or learning outcomes. Its primary purpose is to report achievement of learning goals rather than comparing students to each other.

What distinguishes students' grades in criterion-referenced assessment?

In criterion-referenced assessment, students with the same level of expertise achieve the same grades, and a cut point is used to distinguish between failed and successful students.

What are the characteristics of norm-referenced tests?

Norm-referenced tests include items of average difficulty and high discriminating power, leading to a broad range of scores. This wide score distribution allows for

the clear identification of students' relative positions. The tests are designed to be of average difficulty, ensuring that items are neither too easy nor too challenging. This balance is essential, as overly challenging items would result in low scores across the board, making it impossible to distinguish high-ability students, while very easy items could be solved by lower-ability students, eliminating the ability to differentiate. Norm-referenced tests encompass standardized aptitude tests, achievement tests, teacher-made survey tests, interest inventories, and adjustment inventories.

Lesson:3

ASSESSMENT, TESTING AND NATIONAL CURRICULUM

Topic 007: Role of National Curriculum in Assessment

What are the four levels into which the learning of students is classified in the national curriculum of Pakistan?

Competency

Standards

Benchmarks

Student Learning Outcomes (SLOs)

Define Competency and provide examples of key learning areas.

Competency is a key learning area, such as algebra, arithmetic, geometry in mathematics, and vocabulary, grammar, composition in English.

What do Standards specify in the national curriculum context?

Standards specify broadly the knowledge, skills, and attitudes that students will acquire, should know, and be able to do in a particular key learning area during twelve years of schooling.

Explain Benchmarks and their relation to Standards.

Benchmarks elaborate on the standards, indicating what students will accomplish at the end of each of the five developmental levels to meet the standard.

What are Student Learning Outcomes (SLOs), and how do they fit into the hierarchy of these levels?

SLOs are built on the descriptions of benchmarks and describe what students will accomplish at the end of each grade. They are the lowest level of the hierarchy.

Topic 008: Connecting all Four Levels in Curriculum

In the curriculum structure, what is the position of Student Learning Outcomes (SLOs)?

SLOs are at the bottom, forming the lowest level.

How do SLOs, Benchmarks, Standards, and Competency relate to each other in the curriculum structure?

SLOs combine to create benchmarks, benchmarks convert into standards, and standards contribute to competency.

Provide an example from the English subject curriculum that illustrates the relationship between Competency, Standard, Benchmark, and SLO.

Competency 1: Reading and thinking skills

Standard 1: All students will discover and understand a variety of text types through tasks requiring multiple reading and thinking strategies.

Benchmark 1: Use reading readiness strategies

Student Learning Outcomes: Articulate, identify, and differentiate between sounds of letters, etc.

Topic 009: Modes of Assessment in Curriculum

What forms of assessment are recommended in the curriculum document?

Periodic/formative assessment through homework, quizzes, class tests, and group discussions.

End of term/summative assessment through final examinations.

What should the assessment system for the curriculum include according to **"Purpose of Assessment and Curriculum-English 2006"?**

A clear statement of the specific purpose(s) for assessment.

A wide variety of assessment tools and techniques to measure language effectiveness.

Criteria for determining performance levels for the SLOs at each grade level.

Procedures for interpreting and using assessment results to evaluate learning outcomes.

What are some suitable assessment tools listed in "Form of Suitable Assessment Tools- English 2006"?

MCQs

Constructed response (including restricted and extended response)

Performance tasks

Lesson 04

TAXONOMIES OF EDUCATIONAL OBJECTIVES AND ASSESSMENT –I

Topic 010: Taxonomies of Educational Objectives and Assessment

What are the three important pillars upon which every assessment rests?

A model for how students present knowledge and develop competence in the subject domain.

Tasks or situations that allow the examiner to observe the students' performance.

Inferences from performance evidence about the quality of learning.

Name three popular taxonomies used in educational assessment.

Bloom's taxonomy of educational objectives

Structure of Observed Learning Outcomes (SOLO)

Depth of Knowledge (DOK)

Topic 011: Bloom's Taxonomy and SOLO Taxonomy

Who initially developed the Structure of Observed Learning Outcomes (SOLO) taxonomy, and when?

The SOLO taxonomy was initially developed by Biggs and Collis in 1982 and later described in more detail by Biggs and Tang in 2007.

How many levels of competency are there in the SOLO taxonomy, and what are they?

There are five levels in the SOLO taxonomy:

Pre-structural

Uni-structural

Multi-structural

Relational

Extended Abstract

How many levels of Depth of Knowledge (DOK) are there, and what do they measure?

There are four levels of DOK, and they measure the complexity of knowledge demonstrated by students on assessments in alignment with curriculum expectations.

Topic 012: SOLO Taxonomy

Explain the characteristics of the "Pre-structural" level in the SOLO taxonomy and provide an example.

Pre-structural: Students acquire bits of unconnected information and respond in a meaningless way.

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Example: Question: "What is your name?" Answer: "What is your name?"

What characterizes the "Uni-structural" level in the SOLO taxonomy, and what are indicative verbs for this level?

Uni-structural: Students demonstrate concrete understanding of a topic but can only respond with one relevant element.

Indicative verbs: identify, memorize, do simple procedures.

Describe the "Multi-structural" level in the SOLO taxonomy and provide indicative verbs.

Multi-structural: Students understand several components, but the understanding of each remains discrete. Ideas and concepts around an issue are disorganized and unrelated.

Indicative verbs: enumerate, classify, describe, list, combine, do algorithms.

Explain what happens at the "Relational" level in the SOLO taxonomy and list some indicative verbs.

Relational: At this level, learners understand the significance of parts in relation to the whole, and ideas and concepts are linked to provide a coherent understanding.

Indicative verbs: compare/contrast, explain causes, integrate, analyze, relate, apply.

Describe the characteristics of the "Extended Abstract" level in the SOLO taxonomy and provide indicative verbs.

Extended Abstract: At this level, learners think hypothetically, synthesize logically, and can transfer understanding to different areas.

Indicative verbs: theorize, generalize, hypothesize, reflect, generate.

Topic 013: Depth of Knowledge

How many levels are there in Depth of Knowledge (DOK), and what does DOK measure?

There are four levels in DOK, and it measures the complexity of knowledge demonstrated by students on assessments in alignment with curriculum expectations.

What does the "Recall" level in DOK involve, and what are some key words associated with it?

Recall: This level involves the recall of facts, information, or procedures. It usually deals with working with facts, terms, or properties.

Key words: list, enlist, name, define, etc.

Explain the "Skill/Concept" level in DOK and provide examples of key words.

Skill/Concept: This level engages some mental processing beyond simple recall or reproduction, often involving using information or conceptual knowledge in more complex ways.

Key words: graph, separate, relate, contrast, narrate, compare, etc.

What characterizes the "Strategic Thinking" level in DOK, and what key words are associated with it?

Strategic Thinking: Items in this category require higher-order thinking processes like analysis and evaluation to solve real-world problems with predictable outcomes.

Key words: argue, critique, formulate.

Describe the "Extended Thinking" level in DOK and provide indicative key words.

Extended Thinking: Learning outcomes at this level demand an extended use of higher-order thinking processes like synthesis, reflection, assessment, and adjustment of plans over time.

Key words: create, synthesize, design, reflect.

Lesson 05

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TAXONOMIES OF EDUCATIONAL OBJECTIVES AND ASSESSMENT –II

Topic 014: Bloom's Taxonomy-I

What are the three main domains of learning that teachers should use to construct lessons?

Cognitive Domain

Affective Domain

Psychomotor Domain

Define the "Cognitive Domain" and describe the major revision between the old and the newer version of the cognitive taxonomy.

Cognitive Domain: This domain involves thinking, understanding, and knowledge.

Major Revision: In the newer version, the two highest forms of cognition have been reversed.

What are the levels in the Cognitive Domain of the old version of Bloom's Taxonomy, and what do they entail?

Levels: Knowledge, Comprehension, Application

Knowledge: Remembering previously learned material.

Comprehension: Grasping the meaning of material without necessarily connecting it to other content.

Application: Using previously learned material in new and concrete situations.

Topic 015: Bloom's Taxonomy-II Analysis

Describe the "Analysis" level in Bloom's Taxonomy and provide some indicative key verbs.

Analysis: Breaking materials or concepts into parts and determining how they relate to each other.

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Indicative key verbs: analyze, categorize, classify, compare, contrast, discover, distinguish, examine, infer, inspect.

Explain the "Evaluation" level in Bloom's Taxonomy and provide indicative key verbs.

Evaluation: Making judgments based on criteria and standards through checking and critiquing.

Indicative key verbs: agree, appraise, assess, award, choose, compare, conclude, criticize, decide, deduct, defend, estimate.

Define the "Revised version of Bloom's Taxonomy" and list the levels with their respective key verbs.

Revised Version: The cognitive domain includes levels such as Remembering, Understanding, Applying, Analyzing, Evaluating, and Creating.

Key verbs: Vary based on the level and include verbs like define, explain, summarize, apply, analyze, evaluate, and create.

Topic 016: Revised version of Bloom's Taxonomy

Explain the concept of "Creating" in the revised Bloom's Taxonomy.

Creating: Putting elements together to form a coherent or functional whole, reorganizing elements into a new pattern or structure through generating, planning, or producing.

How do the levels in the revised Bloom's Taxonomy range from simple to complex?

The levels range from simple to complex, with mastery of each simpler category assumed as a prerequisite to mastery of the next, more complex one.

Topic 017: Instructional Objectives

When discussing instructional objectives in terms of learning outcomes, what is the focus?

The focus is on products, rather than the process of learning.

What are some sources for lists of instructional objectives?

Professional Association standards

State Content Standards

Methods Books

Yearbooks

Encyclopedia of Educational Research

Curriculum Frameworks

Test Manuals

What criteria are important when selecting the final list of objectives?

Completeness

Appropriateness

Soundness

Feasibility

How can general objectives be stated effectively?

General objectives should be specific enough to provide direction for instruction but not so specific that instruction is reduced to training. They should allow for the integration of specific facts and skills into complex responses.

Provide examples of general objectives.

Knows basic terminology

Understands concepts

Relates concepts to everyday observations

Applies principles to new situations

Interprets graphs

Demonstrates a scientific attitude

What is the purpose of specific learning outcomes (SLOs) in relation to general objectives?

SLOs clarify how students can demonstrate that they have achieved the general objectives.

Describe the steps for stating specific outcomes (SLOs).

List representative SLOs below each general objective, starting with an action verb.

Ensure each SLO is relevant to the general objective it describes.

Include enough SLOs to describe student performance.

Keep SLOs free of course content for versatility.

Consult reference materials for complex outcomes.

Add a third level of specificity if needed.

Working on the Next Lessons

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